Indian spy and his aide stopped at a large house on Fairfax Road, which had a distinct wooden dome probably inspired by the Baroque style popular in the UK and France. During the drive, Sartaj told Mathur that Chatar was supposed to have vast knowledge of the pro-Khalistan network in the USA and R&AW secret maneuvers could help recruit this valuable source. Mathur was a man of steely resolve. His only advice to the unprecedented number of agents he recruited in various continents was to look for small details while collecting information and try to filter deception and motive before passing on intelligence reports. This worked to a large extent and his informers had penetrated the top echelons of the government, social organisations and even the scientific community in their various countries. Mathur had encouraged covert action where it was needed and no one in the foreign intelligence community knew his real name.

'There is no standard template for spying,' Mathur used to say. 'You have to use and exploit every possible tool available because spying is a dirty job.'

Chatar was waiting at the door when Mathur's car stopped at the portico. Unlike Jagjit Singh Chohan, Chatar had no bodyguards and his house appeared like any other in the affluent Maryland neighbourhood. Mathur recalled: 'Chatar had prepared a detailed agenda for our encounter. After about ten minutes of informal chat about life in general and the US's freezing weather in particular, he ushered us into his large and dark basement. When he switched on the light, Sartaj and I were shocked. There was a large table in the middle, full of explosives and ultra modern arms.'